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Our ref: H876/PRN/JC/2026-01 16 October 2026

BY HAND

Mr. Wayne Robinson
Principal
Jamaica College
189 Old Hope Road
Kingston 6

Dear Principal Robinson,

Re: Invitation for Jamaica College to take part in Hack 876, Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative)

We write to invite students of Jamaica College to take part in Hack 876, a free, one-day hackathon on Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative) at the Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston, Jamaica. Students in 5th Form through Upper 6th Form from schools across Kingston will work in teams of 3 to 4 to build a working prototype of an idea, then present it to judges from industry.

In 2023 JC's Bluebots won Jamaica's FIRST Tech Challenge championship and became the first Jamaican team to win the MOTIVATE Award at the World Championship, and JC STEAMING UP has brought project-based learning to the whole school since 2021. Padrique Duncan, a JC past student who works at Scotia Investments, is helping Hack 876 as a community partner.

Taking part asks very little of JC. There is no cost to the school or to students, nothing for the school to host, organize or transport, and no class time, because the event is on a Saturday. We ask only for a member of staff to act as our contact, and for teachers to share the opportunity with eligible students and recommend those who would enjoy it. The organizers handle consent forms and the event itself, and families receive safety details before the day. Whether students take part remains a decision for the school and for families.

We wrote to you by email on 16 October 2026 and would be glad to hear from you. To confirm JC's participation, please email info@hack876.com, or ask a member of staff to do so. Campion College and Hillel Academy have confirmed their participation, and we would be honoured to welcome JC students alongside them.

Yours sincerely,

Stefen Ewers
Co-organizer, Hack 876

Nadani Dixon
Co-organizer, Hack 876

Enc.: Hack 876 information booklet for Jamaica College

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INFORMATION BOOKLET FOR THE PRINCIPAL

An invitation for Jamaica College

Build something that should exist.

Date	Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative)
Hours	8:00 AM to 7:30 PM
Venue	Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston, Jamaica
Cost	Free for schools and students

Hack 876 is a one-day build competition for Jamaican secondary-school students. In teams of 3 to 4, students choose a real problem, build a prototype that addresses it, and present it to a panel of judges.

The JC page

www.hack876.com /schools/jamaica-college

Prepared for Mr. Wayne Robinson, Principal

Hack 876 is organized independently of Jamaica College. This booklet sets out what the day involves and what we would ask of the school.

WHY JC

Jamaica College already builds.

In 2023 JC's Bluebots won Jamaica's FIRST Tech Challenge championship with the Inspire Award, then became the first Jamaican team to win the MOTIVATE Award at the World Championship in Houston.

Robotics

The Bluebots took the Inspire Award at FTC Jamaica 2023, and JC's Griffins won the Design Award.

World stage

The MOTIVATE Award at the 2023 FIRST World Championship, a first for a Jamaican team.

JC STEAMING UP

A school-wide STEAM programme since 2021, with 3D printers, drones, robots and project-based learning rooms.

Host school

JC hosted the 2025 FTC Jamaica National Robotics Championship, with 34 schools.

> **"We want to add to that the skills that will enhance the boys' abilities to go out into the world of work."**
>
> Mr. Wayne Robinson, Principal, Jamaica College · Jamaica Observer, August 2024

Hack 876 adds something a timetable cannot easily provide: students from other schools, a fixed deadline, mentors from industry, and judges who ask students to explain their decisions. Teams can build software, AI tools or hardware, so JC's robotics and STEAM students have room to bring what they already know.

What students practise

- Defining a real problem
- Designing, building and testing a solution
- Teamwork with students from other schools
- Explaining their work to judges

These are among the skills assessed in CSEC Information Technology and in CAPE Computer Science and Digital Media. Hack 876 is independent of CXC and the Ministry, and taking part does not count toward any SBA.

THE DAY

One day, from first idea to working demo.

A hackathon is an event where small teams build something from scratch in a single day, then present it to judges. No programming experience is needed: teams also need students who design, research, write and present. Mentors who work in industry help throughout the day.

Many students will be at their first hackathon, and no coding experience is needed.

DATE TENTATIVE Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative)	VENUE CONFIRMED Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston	HOURS 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM. One day, not overnight.
WHO Students in 5th Form through Upper 6th Form	SIZE About 80 students from several schools	TEAMS 3 to 4 students per team

The full schedule

One day, from 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM. Not overnight.

ARRIVE

8:00 AM	Doors open
9:00 AM	Opening
9:20 AM	Keynote
9:35 AM	Challenge reveal

BUILD

9:45 AM	Hacking begins
12:00 PM	Lunch
3:00 PM	Submissions open
4:00 PM	Hacking ends

SHOW

4:15 PM	Judging
5:30 PM	Finalists announced
5:45 PM	Finals

CELEBRATE

6:45 PM	Awards
7:00 PM	Photos + hangout
7:30 PM	That's a wrap

WHAT STUDENTS BUILD

Real problems, working prototypes.

Each team picks a track for inspiration, chooses a real problem within it, and builds a working prototype. The tracks guide ideas. They do not limit them.

Life
Make everyday life better.

Learn
Rethink how people learn.

Culture
Build around Jamaican stories, creativity, language, or culture.

Business
Build for entrepreneurs and small businesses.

Move
Rethink transportation, mobility, and getting around.

Wellbeing
Create something that supports healthier lives.

Resilience
Think climate, infrastructure, emergencies, or community resilience.

Wildcard
Build something nobody asked for.

What teams can make
Websites · Apps · AI tools · Games · Hardware · Data projects · Automations · Agents · Interactive experiences

What we ask every team to do

01
Solve something real.
Start with a problem or moment you actually understand.

02
Make something that works.
A rough demo that runs beats a perfect slide deck.

03
Try something bold.
Take a swing. Judges notice ambition.

04
Know what you built.
Explain how it works, why it matters, and what's next.

WHO WILL BE IN THE ROOM

Judges and organizers.



Dominic Saunders
Judge · Tesla
Campion College · Princeton



Jordan Howell
Judge · Microsoft
Campion College · Kettering



Joshua Ardito
Judge · Meta
Campion College · Carnegie Mellon



Tahj Atkinson
Judge · Google
Campion College · Illinois Tech



Kendall Todd
Judge · Accenture
Hillel Academy · UF



Netania Mundell
Judge · Diageo
St. Andrew High School for Girls · UWI · NYU



Sheneska Williams
Judge · HashiCorp (Terraform)
Immaculate Conception High School · USF

ORGANIZERS



Nadani Dixon
Organizer · Redfin
Campion College · Middlebury · Georgia Tech



Stefen Ewers
Organizer · Georgia Tech
Campion College · Hillel Academy · Georgia Tech

Organisations are each person's employer, listed for context. They are not event sponsors unless stated.

Confirmed schools: Campion College, Hillel Academy

CONFIRMED SPONSORS

P237 Labs · organizing partner · Lev Beauty · Vault Motors · Norus Technologies · Frankies

HOW WORK IS JUDGED

How the judges decide.

Each team demonstrates its project to the judges. These are the lenses they use, in plain language. There are no point values.

Problem & Insight
Did you find something worth fixing, and do you get why it matters?

Product & Solution
Does your idea actually answer the problem?

Execution
Does it work? How much did you really build today?

Originality
Is it fresh, or a new take on something familiar?

Impact
Who would this help, and how much?

Pitch & Demo
Can you show it and explain it clearly?

Complexity alone does not win Hack 876.

Prizes

Hack 876 Winner	iPad per student (up to 4)
Second Place	AirPods Pro per student (up to 4)
Third Place	US$150 gift card per student (up to 4)
Best Design	US$50 gift card per student (up to 4)
Boldest Idea	US$200 team project grant
People's Choice	US$50 gift card per student (up to 4)

Prizes are tentative and subject to change.

Prizes are a bonus; the experience of building is the point.

No. Hack 876 does not offer or promise internships, jobs, scholarships, interviews or placements.

SAFETY, SUPERVISION AND COST

What families and the school can rely on.

Supervision
Students are supervised by Hack 876 staff and volunteers for the whole day, at the Spanish Court Hotel.

One day
It is not overnight. Hack 876 runs for a single day, from 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM, and every student goes home that evening.

Access and medical needs
Tell the organizers as early as possible, at info@hack876.com, so arrangements can be made with the venue.

AI tools
Students use only organizer-approved, age-appropriate tools. Students under 18 will not use adults-only tools at Hack 876, with or without permission.

Consent
Every participant needs a consent form signed by a parent or guardian. This applies whatever the student's age.

Food
Food is provided on the day, and the schedule includes a lunch break. Accepted students will be asked about allergies and dietary needs in advance.

Emergencies
Every family will be given an on-site contact and the emergency procedure before the event.

Conduct
The Code of Conduct and Event Rules are at www.hack876.com/code-of-conduct and www.hack876.com/rules.

Not provided

Transport: No transport has been arranged, so families should plan to bring students to the Spanish Court Hotel for 8:00 AM and collect them at 7:30 PM.

Devices: Every student needs to bring their own laptop or other device to build on, plus a charger. Hack 876 is not providing laptops or other hardware.

Cost

Hack 876 is free. There is no fee for the school or for students.

Being finalised, shared with families before the event

- **Supervision:** The number of supervising adults and the written safeguarding procedures.
- **On-site contact:** The on-site contact details.
- **AI tools:** Which tools are approved, and the age limit for each.
- **Consent form:** The exact wording of the form and how it is returned.
- **Arrival and collection:** Drop-off and pick-up procedures, and whether any transport will be arranged.
- **Food:** The menu.

NEXT STEPS

What we ask of JC.

- Confirm JC's participation by email to info@hack876.com.
- Name a member of staff as our contact.
- Share the opportunity with eligible students in 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, and recommend those who would enjoy it.
- Advise us on school permissions and on communication with parents.

JC is not asked to pay, host, organize, transport or supervise anything.

For planning, we have roughly 8 to 12 JC students in mind: an estimate, not a quota or a promise.

First	An email to info@hack876.com confirming JC's participation and naming a staff contact.
If JC agrees	Support in principle, and a school-side contact.
Then	Teachers share the opportunity, and boys apply.
Before the event	Accepted students and their families receive consent forms.
Event day	Hack 876, Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative).

Email info@hack876.com to confirm JC's participation

We wrote to you by email on 16 October 2026 and would be glad to hear from you.

Stefen Ewers and Nadani Dixon, co-organizers · info@hack876.com

Prefer to talk first? Book 15 minutes: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min

At JC, work is burning in the fields.

Let's give a few JC boys one day to build something real.

Hack 876

www.hack876.com

The JC page

www.hack876.com /schools/jamaica-college